

TRENDS 2010

JUMPSUIT

Keep them short and sweet; better yet if the lower half is styled as harem pants

WHITES AND NUDE COLOURS

It gives a sense of cool comfort. Summery colours like yellows, greens, pink and blues will also be a big hit.

LAYERING

Layer in a way that each garment is visible. Shimmery bikini tops peeking from below were a big hit on the ramp.

ONE SHOULDER BLOUSES

Baring a shoulder is fashionable this season. Team your shirts or blouses with shorts, skirts or tights.

FLUID SILHOUETTES

With more fabric and a flowy summery look, it gives clothes a more feminine and comfortable feel

SHEERS

The transparent look goes with the layering trend and keeps you cool in the summer

per cent were domestic. The number of international buyer companies has risen by 114 per cent. Sujal Shah, fashion head of IMG India, says, "India has two main seasons—summer and winter. We don't have spring and autumn, so it made more sense to have a summer-resort season. It also ensured overseas buyers were clear about what to expect."

Pradeep Hirani of the Kimaya range of stores says India has the potential to carve a niche for itself as a resort wear destination. "People look to India for resort wear, not winter clothes. We can carve a niche the way Brazil has done with swimwear." But not all is as rosy as painted by the organisers. Alka Nishar of Aza is disappointed. "I was expecting something unique," she says. Nishar is also not sure how soon clothes can hit stores as deadlines vary with designers.

Designers' response shows that it's too early to jump to conclusions. For Pria Kataaria Puri, who has almost exclusively been making resort wear for the last five years, it

is a vindication of sorts. "I have got a lot of recognition and it proves that this is what people want," she says. As for immediate benefits of the shift, not much has changed. Puri's format remains the same as she will retail in July-August; her buyers are the ones she has worked with earlier. There are two new international buyers but neither has come through LEW.

There have also been hiccups along the way. Designers had already showed spring-summer collections in September last year, so it meant a repeat within six months. That's why Nachiket Barve showed a fall-winter collection. He says, "I already have a spring collection that will be retailing till August, so doing a new collection will kill the old one." The shift posed challenges for designers who had already started work on an autumn-winter line. GenNext designer Sougat Paul is happy that he has got both local as well as foreign buyers with his very first show, but he

adds, "For local buyers, it should be very good, but it gets a bit confusing as the international cycle is winter." For him it meant making certain changes after learning that the season was Summer-Resort.

The new season was to ensure clothes retailed sooner but that too is not happening. Designers with bulk orders are still following late deadlines. The main beneficiaries are the newer ones with smaller orders like Masaba, whose collection will be available at six outlets from March 16. Shantanu and Nikhil who have tied-up with Adidas will be retailing from March 10. Though these tie-ups can't be credited to LEW completely, it does show that the collections are wanted in the market much earlier.

Overall, there were mixed reactions to the change and everyone seems to be waiting before giving a final verdict. Even as the LEW closes with a high octane grand finale by designer Suneet Verma, the Indian fashion market has never been as closely watched—by its own. ■